

The 2026 Marketing, Advertising, Content, Website & Digital Services Public-Sector Opportunity Playbook

A source-backed guide to communications procurement, public-information campaigns, accessible digital services, funded recipients, prime partners, and buyer routes.

8 lanes Communications, outreach, content, web, accessibility, analytics, recipient, and prime routes	3 systems SAM.gov, USAspending, and Grants.gov evidence paths	30 days A qualification-led pursuit plan
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Built for founders and revenue teams that need credible targets, clear revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions - not a generic list of grants or contracts.

Opportunity Scanner by Opportunity Systems

Research current as of July 27, 2026. Always recheck time-sensitive official sources before acting.

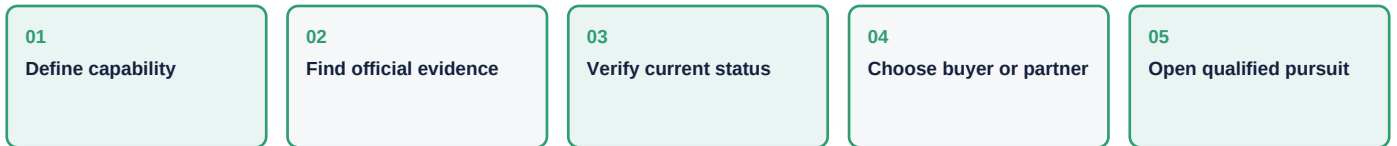
The opportunity landscape

Use these lanes to separate records that imply different buyers, partners, timing, and next actions.

8 evidence lanes to investigate



From signal to an owned revenue action



These diagrams are operating maps, not a promise that every lane is open. The report explains the evidence, constraints, and qualification checks behind each route.

Updated July 27, 2026. Regulations, acquisition forecasts, notices, awards, budgets, and vendor routes are time-sensitive and must be rechecked before publication and before action.

Offer and audience

This report is for marketing agencies, advertising firms, content studios, web and digital-service teams, public-relations firms, media buyers, research shops, video producers, accessibility specialists, and independent consultants pursuing public-sector revenue.

It is not a directory of government marketing contacts. It is an operating guide for separating demand signals that lead to different buyers, contract routes, partners, evidence requirements, and next actions.

Executive brief

Public-sector demand is broader than campaign creative. Governments and publicly funded organizations need residents to understand services, complete forms, adopt safer behaviors, use benefits, attend programs, apply for jobs, visit destinations, and trust official information. That demand can produce advertising, research, media, content, web, accessibility, analytics, translation, video, public relations, and implementation work.

Digital delivery has become mission infrastructure. On July 13, 2026, GSA's live Digital Analytics Program dashboard reported 1.68 billion sessions during the prior 30 days across participating federal websites and apps. The figure is dynamic, sampled, and not the entire public-sector internet, but it demonstrates the scale at which government content and digital experiences operate.

Two current policy frameworks shape the market. Federal executive agencies remain subject to the 21st Century IDEA and OMB M-23-22 digital-experience framework. State and local governments face the Department of Justice Title II web and mobile accessibility rule, with an April 2026 interim final rule extending the WCAG 2.1 Level AA compliance dates to April 26, 2027 for entities serving 50,000 or more people and April 26, 2028 for smaller entities and special district governments.

Neither framework is a purchase order. It is evidence of requirements and institutional demand. A useful opportunity still needs a named owner, funded scope, acquisition or partnership route, and time-bound next action.

The most practical market-entry wedge is usually one repeatable public outcome: enrollment, recruitment, public awareness, service adoption, accessible transactions, destination demand, stakeholder engagement, or digital self-service. Package creative services around that outcome, then prove accessibility, measurement, privacy awareness, production capacity, and government-ready delivery.

State of the market: seven signals shaping 2026 demand

1. Digital communication and service delivery are converging

The federal digital-experience framework calls for accessible, authoritative, understandable, discoverable, secure, user-centered, data-informed, and mobile-first websites and services. It also directs agencies to digitize forms and maximize self-service where practicable.

Business implication: A website engagement may combine content strategy, information architecture, user research, search, analytics, design, development, accessibility, governance, and ongoing optimization. Firms that sell only a visual redesign can miss the operational scope.

Recommended action: Lead with a measurable public task. Show how content, design, technology, accessibility, and analytics improve completion or comprehension rather than presenting a generic brand refresh.

2. The state and local accessibility deadline moved, but implementation demand did not disappear

DOJ's 2026 interim final rule extended the Title II web and mobile accessibility dates by one year. Covered state and local entities still generally must meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA, including content or apps made available through contractual, licensing, or other arrangements. Larger entities now have until April 26, 2027; smaller entities and special district governments have until April 26, 2028.

Business implication: The extension creates a planning and remediation window, not permission to ignore accessibility. Buyers may need inventory, testing, remediation, content migration, document work, design-system updates, vendor governance, training, and sustainable publishing processes.

Recommended action: Confirm the entity category, digital estate, owner, procurement route, and remediation plan. Do not promise legal compliance from an overlay, automated scan, or one-time audit.

3. Federal acquisition channels explicitly recognize this service family

GSA's Multiple Award Schedule includes advertising services, public relations, marketing research and analysis, web-based marketing, graphic design, video production, event support, and related other direct costs in its Marketing and Public Relations subcategory. The service descriptions include public awareness, complex-issue communication, recruitment, media planning and placement, research, web design and maintenance, social media, Section 508 work, captioning, and campaign evaluation.

Business implication: The market has established acquisition language and contract channels. It also has incumbents and vehicle holders. Exact Special Item Number alignment does not prove a buyer will use MAS, and an agency does not need every capability from one firm.

Recommended action: Map the offer to the buyer's language, likely NAICS and SIN structure, and realistic route: direct prime, schedule holder, subcontract, or local procurement.

4. Public demand often appears before an open solicitation

Agency acquisition forecasts, sources-sought notices, requests for information, strategic plans, accessibility inventories, public meeting records, adopted budgets, expiring awards, and campaign calendars can reveal a requirement before final competition.

Business implication: Waiting only for an RFP compresses discovery and teaming. Treating a forecast as guaranteed revenue wastes effort. The value is early qualification: likely office, incumbent, scope, vehicle, timing, and partner need.

Recommended action: Pair planning evidence with SAM.gov, agency forecasts, USAspending, state or local portals, and current budget records. Create a monitor milestone instead of inventing a deadline.

5. Funded recipients create a second buyer layer

Federal grants and cooperative agreements flow to states, localities, universities, health systems, transit agencies, workforce organizations, nonprofits, and other implementers. During post-award work, recipients may need outreach, enrollment, public meetings, websites, reporting content, creative production, translation, community engagement, or evaluation.

Business implication: An award is money promised to a recipient for an approved purpose, not an available marketing budget. Recipient purchasing rules, approved scope, project period, internal capacity, and competition requirements still control.

Recommended action: Read the award description and implementation plan. Choose Sell to Funded Buyer or Sell to Award Recipient only when the service is plausibly allowable and the recipient has a documented need or procurement route.

6. Evidence, accessibility, privacy, and message authority shape the deliverable

Federal content has plain-writing obligations. Federal digital work also sits inside accessibility, privacy, records, security, and analytics requirements. GAO has documented government-wide restrictions on using appropriations for publicity or propaganda while also finding properly scoped agency communication services permissible in a specific HHS matter.

Business implication: Public-sector creative review can involve program, legal, accessibility, privacy, security, communications, and contracting stakeholders. Commercial tactics cannot be copied without understanding authority, data collection, approvals, records, and audience obligations.

Recommended action: Ask who approves claims, owns data, handles consent and records, validates accessibility, and authorizes media. Price review cycles, testing, and version control into delivery.

7. Ongoing operations can be more valuable than a launch

Government information changes. Benefits, deadlines, emergency guidance, grants, events, regulations, forms, and leadership pages require maintenance. OMB's federal framework expects ongoing remediation and data-informed improvement; DOJ's state and local rule requires continued accessibility after the applicable date.

Business implication: Content operations, analytics, governance, accessibility testing, maintenance, campaign optimization, and surge capacity can become recurring work. A one-time redesign without ownership and maintenance may create a fragile result.

Recommended action: Offer a defined operating model: content inventory, service levels, approval workflow, analytics review, accessibility regression testing, and quarterly improvement backlog.

Eight opportunity lanes

Lane	Evidence and likely target	Revenue Motion	First validation
Active communications procurement	Current RFP, RFQ, task order, or bid from an agency communications or program office	Sell to Agency	Status, scope, evaluation, vehicle, deadline, incumbent, response instructions
Website and digital-service modernization	Digital plan, redesign notice, form digitization, analytics finding, content migration, service backlog	Sell to Agency; Channel / Distribut or Motion	Service owner, technology boundary, accessibility, security, hosting, procurement route
Accessibility remediation and governance	DOJ Title II plan, Section 508 requirement, audit, inventory, training need, document backlog	Sell to Agency; Sell to Funded Buyer	Applicable framework, entity category, deadline, estate size, testing method, owner
Public-information and behavior campaign	Program launch, safety initiative, enrollment target, emergency readiness, public-health or benefits outreach	Sell to Agency	Statutory or program purpose, audience, message authority, media budget, success measure
Tourism, workforce, and place marketing	Destination plan, talent attraction program, recruitment campaign, civic event, economic-development initiative	Sell to Agency; Sell to Funded Buyer	Producing office, adopted budget, audience, season, media ownership, local procurement
Funded-recipient implementation	Grant or cooperative agreement to a state, locality, university, nonprofit, or other implementer	Sell to Funded Buyer; Sell to Award Recipient; Partner with Recipient	Active period, approved scope, allowable service, purchasing authority, downstream competition
Prime, vehicle-holder, and production channel	Prior prime award, schedule holder, integrator, media buyer, production vendor, translation or research partner	Channel / Distribut or Motion; Sell to Award Recipient	Contract relevance, separable work package, flow-downs, exclusivity, customer access, timing
Forecast, policy, and budget intelligence	Acquisition forecast, expiring award, proposed budget, digital inventory, policy milestone, public meeting	Monitor Policy; Research Only	Adoption status, named owner, funding source, conversion event, next review date

Demand-to-buyer route map

Route A: Agency mission to communications procurement

Trigger: An agency needs public awareness, enrollment, recruitment, behavior change, event participation, or stakeholder understanding.

Likely path: Program office defines the outcome; communications and legal shape the message; procurement selects the route; a contractor executes research, creative, production, media, outreach, or measurement.

Best contact path: Program owner plus procurement contact. Use the source-native contact in the notice when one exists. The public information officer may advise but may not control the contract.

Route B: Digital requirement to service owner

Trigger: A website, form, mobile app, or public transaction needs modernization, content work, accessibility, search, analytics, or maintenance.

Likely path: Digital service or program owner works with CIO/IT, communications, accessibility, privacy, security, legal, and contracting staff. A platform prime may control implementation.

Best contact path: Digital experience lead, web manager, product owner, Section 508 or ADA coordinator, and contracting office. Ask who owns the backlog and acquisition plan.

Route C: Grant program to funded implementer

Trigger: An assistance award requires implementation, outreach, recruitment, engagement, public meetings, education, or reporting.

Likely path: Federal agency awards a recipient; the recipient approves a communications need and procures or partners under applicable rules.

Best contact path: Recipient project director or communications lead, then grants/procurement staff. Validate the award period and allowable scope before pitching.

Route D: Large contract to specialist partner

Trigger: A prime, schedule holder, integrator, media firm, research contractor, or platform vendor needs a specialist, local network, production team, accessibility capability, or surge capacity.

Likely path: Agency awards or plans a broad requirement; prime shapes work packages and manages flow-down requirements; specialist supports delivery.

Best contact path: Prime program manager, capture lead, partner manager, or subcontract administrator. Lead with a specific gap you close, not a general capability deck.

Route E: Local plan to future buying event

Trigger: A city, county, district, authority, college, or tourism body adopts a plan, budget, event calendar, rebrand, accessibility roadmap, or public-engagement initiative.

Likely path: Sponsoring office obtains budget and approvals; procurement method depends on value, local rules, cooperative contracts, rosters, and existing vendors.

Best contact path: Sponsoring department and purchasing office. Ask about the procurement calendar, threshold, incumbent, roster, or cooperative vehicle.

Qualification framework

Score each factor 0, 1, or 2. A high-authority source can still produce a low-actionability row.

Dimension	0 - reject or monitor	1 - validate	2 - pursue
Outcome fit	Generic marketing keyword	Plausible audience or channel fit	Exact public outcome and deliverable match
Record status	Expired, historical, or proposed only	Dated plan, forecast, or active award	Live notice, funded task, approved project, or partner intake
Buyer control	Organization only	Office or recipient identified	Budget owner and acquisition or partner controller named
Route clarity	No viable access path	Direct or partner hypothesis	Confirmed portal, vehicle, roster, subcontract, or purchase process
Compliance fit	Material unknowns	Gaps have an owner and plan	Accessibility, privacy, security, records, and content controls fit
Delivery proof	Portfolio is commercial and generic	Adjacent regulated or public proof	Comparable audience, outcome, scale, and approval environment
Timing and economics	Deadline missed or cost-to-win fails	Window plausible; budget unclear	Milestone, budget logic, margin, and capacity align
Contact and action	Generic cold pitch	Role known; question not tested	Source-native contact, precise question, owner, and due date

Interpretation: 13-16 points with no hard-gate failure is High Actionability. 8-12 is Medium and needs named validation. 0-7 is Low, Research Only, or reject.

Hard gates: Reject or pause when the deadline is closed, the entity is ineligible, the route is unavailable, the firm cannot meet a mandatory accessibility/security/registration requirement, the deliverable would create an unmanageable conflict, or the economics cannot support a credible response.

Buyer and contact paths

Need	Likely operational owner	Procurement or partner path	First evidence-led question
Public awareness or enrollment	Program director, communications director, public information office	Agency procurement, existing communications vehicle, media or research prime	Who owns the outcome, audience research, message approval, and buying process?
Website or digital service	Product owner, web manager, digital experience lead, CIO/IT	IT or professional-services procurement, platform prime, cooperative contract	Is the need a redesign, service transaction, content operation, accessibility backlog, or maintenance task?
Accessibility	ADA coordinator, Section 508 program manager, digital lead, compliance office	ICT procurement, audit/remediation contract, training or content-service order	Which estate and standard are in scope, and who accepts testing evidence?
Content and editorial operations	Communications lead, program content owner, web governance lead	Communications contract, digital-services order, staff augmentation	What publishing volume, approval workflow, plain-language, translation, and accessibility requirements apply?
Paid media and creative production	Campaign manager, communications office, program owner	Advertising SIN/contract, media buyer, creative or production prime	Is media included, who controls placement, and how are commissions, approvals, and performance measured?
Research and evaluation	Insights lead, program evaluator, communications strategy owner	Research contract, schedule holder, evaluation prime	What decision will the research change, and are recruitment, privacy, and instrument approvals defined?
Funded-recipient outreach	Grant project director, recipient communications or engagement lead	Recipient procurement, subaward, implementation partnership	Does the approved project require this work, and what selection rules and project dates control?
Prime or channel support	Prime program manager, capture lead, partner manager	Subcontract, teaming agreement, task-order partner, local production network	Which work package is uncovered, when is the team locked, and what flow-downs apply?

Source-to-action matrix

Official source	What it can prove	What it cannot prove	Recommended action
SAM.gov Contract Opportunities	Federal notice type, office, dates, contact, attachments, amendments	Vendor fit, award likelihood, state/local demand	Read the full record; follow amendments; respond through the stated route
Acquisition.gov forecast directory	Agency links to anticipated procurements and industry liaisons	Final scope, value, release date, set-aside, or guarantee	Research incumbent and office; create a dated monitor and validation question

Official source	What it can prove	What it cannot prove	Recommended action
USAspending	Reported recipient, award, agency, obligations, period, description	Open competition, unused budget, downstream buying intent	Map incumbent or funded recipient; verify active scope and related procurements
GSA Multiple Award Schedule	Established federal service categories and available schedule route	That a buyer will use MAS or select a listed firm	Map capability to the likely SIN; assess direct holder or partner strategy
Digital.gov and OMB M-23-22	Federal digital-experience requirements and implementation framework	A funded project or universal contract scope	Find agency inventories, plans, forecasts, awards, and responsible offices
ADA.gov and 2026 Federal Register rule	Current state/local standard and extended compliance dates	An entity's present conformance, budget, or vendor decision	Confirm entity category, estate, plan, procurement, and legal interpretation
Section508.gov	Federal ICT accessibility requirements, roles, tools, and testing resources	Automatic compliance or applicability to state/local Title II	Align evidence and testing to the stated federal requirement and buyer acceptance
Grants.gov	Federal assistance notice and lifecycle	Commercial vendor eligibility or recipient purchasing intent	Separate Direct Apply from downstream recipient work; inspect award and scope
Local budgets, agendas, plans, and portals	Approved initiatives, owners, spending authority, solicitations, awards	That planned funds are uncommitted or outsourced	Pair the plan with procurement status and the sponsoring office
Analytics.usa.gov	Directional traffic and behavior for participating federal sites/apps	Full government traffic, exact unsampled totals, or buying demand	Use as context; build account-level analytics and outcome evidence

The Opportunity Scanner method for this market

Step 1: Define the public outcome

Choose the outcome the firm can improve: awareness, comprehension, enrollment, recruitment, service completion, visitation, compliance, engagement, or trust. Name the audience and behavior.

Step 2: Build a government-ready capability profile

Document research, strategy, creative, production, media, content, web, accessibility, analytics, language, geography, scale, partners, tools, past performance, registrations, insurance, and lead times. Separate work performed in-house from partner capabilities.

Step 3: Search by mission and deliverable

Combine audience and outcome terms with operational nouns: outreach, campaign, enrollment, recruitment, media, content migration, website maintenance, accessibility, user research, public meeting, video, translation, analytics, or creative services.

Step 4: Classify the evidence

Assign one status: active procurement, pre-solicitation, funded recipient, prior award, planned initiative, regulatory deadline, partner route, or research only. Preserve publication, deadline, award-period, and retrieval dates.

Step 5: Map controller, approvers, and beneficiaries

Name the program owner, communications owner, procurement controller, technical or accessibility approver, prime or recipient, and public audience. Contact strategy follows control, not prominence on the website.

Step 6: Select one Revenue Motion

Use Sell to Agency for a documented government purchase; Sell to Funded Buyer or Sell to Award Recipient for supported downstream needs; Partner with Recipient for collaborative delivery; Channel / Distributor Motion for prime, media, platform, or vehicle access; Monitor Policy or Research Only when no current transaction is supported.

Step 7: Score and apply hard gates

Score outcome fit, status, control, route, compliance, proof, economics, and next action. Reject weak keyword matches and opportunities that require unavailable registrations, capacity, access, or mandatory proof.

Step 8: Create an evidence-led action

Ask who owns the digital backlog, confirm an upcoming procurement, register in the correct local portal, validate an award scope, request a prime-work-package discussion, or prepare a campaign-specific capability note. Attach the source and deadline.

Worked illustrative example

Company context: A 20-person agency provides audience research, multilingual content, accessible web design, paid media, video, and analytics for regulated clients.

Signals: A county adopted a benefits-enrollment goal; its digital plan identifies high abandonment on mobile forms; an accessibility roadmap covers public web content; prior award records name a platform integrator; the procurement forecast shows a future digital-services requirement; and a current media contract expires in nine months.

Interpretation: The plan proves an outcome and owner, not an open purchase. The accessibility roadmap creates a constraint and workstream, not automatic budget. The integrator may control technical implementation. The expiring media award and forecast provide timing signals that require validation.

Primary motion: Channel / Distributor Motion with the platform integrator for accessible content, research, and conversion work if the work package is separable.

Secondary motion: Sell to Agency for the future campaign or media requirement after confirming the procurement route and incumbent strategy.

Next action: Ask the county digital owner whether form-content and accessibility remediation sit inside the integrator's scope, then approach the prime with a two-page capability brief tied to mobile completion, multilingual content, WCAG testing, and analytics. Create a monitor 120 days before the media contract end date. This example is illustrative and does not describe a customer result.

30-day action plan

Days 1-5: Choose the wedge

Select one public outcome, two service packages, two buyer types, and two geographies. Complete the capability profile and define hard gates for accessibility, security, data, registrations, media economics, capacity, and conflicts.

Days 6-10: Build the evidence set

Collect 30 official records: ten active or forecast procurement records, eight prior awards or incumbents, six funded-recipient or program records, and six plans, budgets, accessibility, or digital-experience signals. Time-stamp every record.

Days 11-15: Map buyers and routes

For each record, name the program owner, communications or digital owner, procurement controller, approvers, recipient or prime, Revenue Motion, contact path, and missing validation. Remove generic organization-only rows.

Days 16-20: Score and select

Apply the 16-point score and hard gates. Choose five High Actionability pursuits and five Medium monitors. Reject expired notices, unsupported grant-recipient assumptions, and opportunities with no viable route.

Days 21-25: Prepare route-specific proof

Create one public-outcome capability brief, one accessibility and governance evidence sheet, one prime-partner brief, and two short case summaries with audience, constraint, intervention, measure, and result. Do not imply public past performance that the firm does not have.

Days 26-30: Execute and review

Complete ten evidence-led actions: source-contact questions, forecast-owner outreach, local vendor registration, prime introductions, recipient-scope validation, or scheduled monitor tasks. Record responses, disqualifications, next dates, and repeated language. End with a pursue, partner, monitor, or close decision for every row.

Limits and responsible use

- This report is not legal, procurement, grant, accessibility, privacy, records, security, advertising, appropriations, or eligibility advice.
- DOJ's April 2026 interim final rule extended state and local compliance dates. Recheck the final regulatory text and current ADA.gov guidance before relying on a date.
- WCAG conformance, Section 508, and Title II are not interchangeable labels. Confirm the applicable authority and acceptance method.
- An automated accessibility scan or overlay is not proof of full conformance or legal compliance.
- The 1.68 billion session figure is a dynamic July 13, 2026 snapshot for DAP-participating federal sites and apps; reports are sampled and directional.
- A GSA SIN describes an acquisition category. It does not prove an agency will use MAS, that a firm qualifies, or that a requirement is open.
- A forecast, plan, budget, deadline, or policy creates intelligence, not a guaranteed purchase.
- A prior contract identifies an incumbent and buying history, not an open recompetes or remaining ceiling.
- A grant recipient is not automatically a buyer, and an award amount is not a communications budget.
- Public-sector communications may require additional message, legal, privacy, records, accessibility, translation, and security review.
- Recheck every source, attachment, amendment, deadline, award period, procurement rule, and contact before action.

Evidence and source ledger

Claim or use	Official primary source	Period / retrieval	Caveat
Live federal digital traffic context: 1.68B sessions in prior 30 days	GSA Digital Analytics Program, official source	Snapshot retrieved 2026-07-13	Dynamic, sampled, directional data for participating federal sites and apps; not full public-sector traffic.
Federal digital-experience requirements and implementation priorities	GSA Digital.gov, official source	Retrieved 2026-07-13	Policy summary; OMB memorandum and agency-specific decisions control.
OMB M-23-22 policy text	Office of Management and Budget, official source	Issued 2023-09-22; retrieved 2026-07-13	Recheck current OMB policy and agency implementation.
2026 extension to April 2027 and April 2028 Title II compliance dates	Federal Register, official source	Effective 2026-04-20; retrieved 2026-07-13	Interim final rule; recheck current regulatory status and official edition.
Current DOJ summary, WCAG 2.1 AA standard, entity tiers, and contractual coverage	U.S. Department of Justice, official source	Updated for 2026 IFR; retrieved 2026-07-13	Introductory guidance; full rule, exceptions, and legal advice control.
Federal Section 508 acquisition requirements and responsible roles	GSA Section508.gov, official source	Reviewed 2025-03; retrieved 2026-07-13	Federal ICT framework; do not substitute it for state/local Title II analysis.
Marketing, PR, web, research, design, video, media, and event service categories	U.S. General Services Administration, official source	Live schedule page; retrieved 2026-07-13	Category and SIN descriptions do not prove an open order or buyer route.
Agency acquisition-forecast and industry-liaison directory	Acquisition.gov, official source	Live directory; retrieved 2026-07-13	Forecasts are planning signals and can change.
Current federal contract notices and source-native contacts	SAM.gov, official source	Live system; retrieved 2026-07-13	Notice and attachments control; amendments and status can change.
Award, obligation, recipient, and spending interpretation	USAspending, official source	Live guide; retrieved 2026-07-13	Award data can be revised and does not prove downstream purchasing intent.
Prime and subcontract routes for small businesses	U.S. Small Business Administration, official source	Updated 2026-03-13; retrieved 2026-07-13	Subcontract availability and flow-down terms are contract-specific.
Federal plain-writing requirement for covered public documents	GovInfo, Public Law 111-274, official source	Enacted 2010-10-13; retrieved 2026-07-13	Statutory scope applies to covered federal documents.
Communication-services appropriations analysis	U.S. Government Accountability Office, official source	Decision issued 2023-11-16; retrieved 2026-07-13	Fact-specific decision; not blanket approval of campaigns or spending.

Put this guide to work

Opportunity Scanner reads your company website, finds source-backed public-sector signals, and translates them into target organizations, revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions.

Run a free company scan at opportunityscanner.ai

Recheck official sources before any outreach, application, registration, or bid decision.